

guys can see what the real needs are, they don't always get enough time to fathom the possibilities. We do put them through the paces and handhold them for some time, but eventually, we have to tell them it's time they started on their own," says Khandpur.

Cases In Point

There has been a wide range of movies that have either undergone the DI process or had a great amount of VFX in them. Some of these you know about, some you don't. Presenting an exposé:

Kal Ho Na Ho: A love story with virtually no action scenes, you must wonder where the VFX were. "There are a couple of scenes where it was required that VFX step in. The movie was shot on location in the US and there was a scene when snow was required. The director ordered only one snow machine thinking it would be enough, but when they started shooting, it was less than adequate. After talking to us, we gave a solution: just make sure the two main actors in the scene were covered with snow, and we'll take care of the rest. You couldn't even tell that the snow was added later," reveals Khandpur.

Dhoom: Here was a movie with loads of SFX. Not just VFX, but plenty of special ones! "This was an out-and-out action thriller, and there was plenty of scope to work on it. Take for example the stunt scene where the motorcycle rider has to jump over a rake... we were on the set when they shot it and everyone was like 'Wow'. But when we saw the scene a little more objectively, the thrill was missing. The scene showed the motorcyclist jumping over an empty rake between two bogeys. What we realised was that the rake was too long and this took the thrill away... so we reduced the length of this! The effect was superb," says Khandpur.

"Another scene where we got the chance to add some special effects was the one after the title song-and-dance sequence. In this one, there are lines of petrol spill along the ramp, and these are supposed to be lit by the actor. He is supposed to fling his Zippo lighter into the petrol. When his close-ups were shot, it hardly looked appealing. But we took this onto the computer and made it dramatic," says Khandpur. Eventually, this movie ended up having over 20 minutes of

Upcoming Movies

Life Ho To Aisi: India's first HD (high-definition) movie. Shot on HD cameras, this children's film will include some great quality visuals.

Ek Ajnabee: Watch out for the fight sequence. Stars Amitabh Bachchan and a little boy!

Home Delivery: One of the most talked-about films of late, this film has a range of effects and of course, DI. Spot the effects if you can!

Bluffmaster: Abhishek Bachchan is led into the computer and the film gets a slick new look and feel.

Dhoom 2: Including pre-visualisation, this film will be planned to the last detail before the shooting even starts. As a matter of fact, a couple of scenes using pre-viz and including VFX specialists and supervisors have already been canned.

special effects... a fact that is not often realised when you watch a movie, and that, perhaps, is the best compliment for the creators!

Mangal Pandey - The Rising: A period film and an epic, this movie has it all: DI, VFX and a great deal of wire stamping!

Assuming you've watched the movie, let's jump right into the scene when Aamir Khan has challenged the might of the British regime. The Rangoon regiment is on its way to handle him and his group of revolutionaries. Now, the very reason this regiment was called in was because it had 50,000 soldiers. Hiring as many people had monetary and logistical implications... actually nightmares. So just about 200 people were shot and then replicated to make the regiment look like it was attacking in all its glory.

Right after this scene is the part where Khan is tried and is about to be hanged. Again, the problem was the number of people that could be realistically had on the sets. Once again, replication was done. This time, though, some 'creation' was also done—and not through the camera. A tent, an elephant and some villagers behind the lead actor were added. Also cleaned up was some lighting equipment that had crept into the shot!

Over the years, as the Indian film industry matures and gets more professional, there is a good possibility that a special effects film could well come out of Bollywood. "We might be a long way away from making our own Matrix-like tech-centred movies, but the signs are positive. Who knows, but soon, we could..." says Khandpur. Amen. ■

aditya_kuber@thinkdigit.com

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